

ABITURPRÜFUNG 2023

zum Erwerb der fachgebundenen / allgemeinen Hochschulreife
an Fachoberschulen und Berufsoberschulen

ENGLISCH

Dienstag, 23. Mai 2023

READING COMPREHENSION TEXTS

09:00 Uhr – 12:30 Uhr

Diese Prüfung besteht aus zwei Teilen:

READING: Tasks I - III (9:00 bis 10:30 Uhr)

Pause von 30 Minuten

WRITING: Mediation D-E / Material-Based Writing (11:00 bis 12:30 Uhr)

Im **READING**-Teil werden Texte und Aufgaben in zwei getrennten Geheften vorgelegt.

Die Aufgaben (**TASKS**) liegen in zwei Varianten (**V1** und **V2**) vor.

Diese sind gemischt auszugeben.

Alle Lösungen sind von den Prüflingen im Aufgabenteil einzutragen.

In der Pause werden die Text- und Aufgabengehefte von den Arbeitsplätzen der Schüler entfernt.

Der **WRITING**-Teil wird erst nach der Pause, also um 11 Uhr, ausgegeben.

Hilfsmittel: Ein einsprachiges Wörterbuch (ggf. auch inkl. Writing Tutor)

Reading Text I:

When tragedy becomes banal: Why news consumers experience crisis fatigue

When Vladimir Putin launched a full-scale invasion of Ukraine by land, air and sea on Feb. 24, 2022, the images of war were conveyed to dismayed onlookers around the world. Far from the action, many of us became aware of the unprovoked aggression by reading online coverage or watching TV to see explosions and people running from danger and crowding into underground
5 bunkers. Half a year later, the violence continues.

But for those who have not been directly affected by the events, this ongoing war and its casualties have been shifting to the periphery of many people's attention. This turning away makes sense. Being attentive to realities like war is often painful, and people are not well-equipped to keep a sustained focus on ongoing or traumatic occurrences. **GAP 1** These
10 include droughts, wildfires, storms tied to global warming and mass shootings.

As the philosopher-psychologist William James asked, "Does not every sudden shock, appearance of a new object, or change in a sensation, create a real interruption?" Ongoing tragic events, like the assault on Ukraine, can recede from people's attention because many may feel overwhelmed, helpless or drawn to other urgent issues. This phenomenon is called "crisis
15 fatigue."

GAP 2 "War fatigue is kicking in," the Estonian prime minister, Kaja Kallas, said. "Russia is playing on us getting tired. We must not fall into the trap."

In a speech to marketing professionals in Cannes, France, the president of Ukraine, Volodymyr Zelenskyy, asked them to keep the world focused on his country's plight. "I'll be honest with you – the end of this war and its circumstances depend on the world's attention ...," he said. "Don't
20 let the world switch to something else!" Unfortunately, many of us have already changed the channel. The tragic has become banal.

GAP 3 On the one hand, attention can put people in touch with the unvarnished lives of others so the afflicted are truly seen and heard. On the other, such openness can overwhelm
25 many of us through vicarious trauma, as psychologists Lisa McCann and Laurie Pearlman have noted. The difficulty of sustained focus on events like the war is due not only to the inherent fragility of moral attention, however. As cultural critics like Neil Postman, James Williams and Maggie Jackson have noted, the 24/7 news cycle is one of many pressures clamoring for our attention. Our smartphones and other technology with incessant communications – from trivial
30 to apocalyptic – engineer environments to keep us perpetually distracted and disoriented.

Aside from the threats to people's attention posed by our distracting technologies and information overload, there is also the fact of crisis fatigue leading readers to consume less news.

This year, a Reuters Institute analysis showed that interest in news has decreased sharply across all markets, from 63% in 2017 to 51% in 2022, while a full 15% of Americans have disconnected
35 from news coverage altogether. **GAP 4** Conservative voters tend to avoid the news because they deem it untrustworthy or biased, while liberal voters avoid news because of feelings of powerlessness and fatigue. Online news, with its perpetual drive to keep eyes trained on screens, is unwittingly undermining its own goals: to provide news and keep the public informed.

How might we recover a capacity for meaningful attention and responses amid incessant,
40 disjointed and overwhelming news? Scholars have made a variety of recommendations.
GAP 5 Beyond this, readers and journalists might consider the following:

Limiting the daily intake of news can help people become more attentive to particular issues of concern without feeling overwhelmed. Cultural theorist Yves Citton, in his book "The Ecology of Attention," urges readers to "extract" themselves "from the hold of the alertness media regime."
45 According to him, the current media creates a state of "permanent alertness" through "crisis discourses, images of catastrophes, political scandals, and violent news items." At the same time, reading long-form articles and essays can actually be a practice that helps with cultivating attentiveness.

Journalists can include more solutions-based stories that capture the possibility of change.
50 **GAP 6** Amanda Ripley, a former Time magazine journalist, notes that "stories that offer hope, agency, and dignity feel like breaking news right now, because we are so overwhelmed with the opposite."

Reading Text II:

A 'reversible' form of death?

The pigs had been lying dead in the lab for an hour — no blood was circulating in their bodies, their hearts were still, their brain waves flat. Then a group of Yale scientists pumped a custom-made solution into the dead pigs' bodies with a device similar to a heart-lung machine.

What happened next adds questions to what science considers the wall between life and death.

- 5 Although the pigs were not considered conscious in any way, their seemingly dead cells revived. Their hearts began to beat as the solution, which the scientists called OrganEx, circulated in veins and arteries. Cells in their organs, including the heart, liver, kidneys and brain, were functioning again, and the animals never got stiff like a typical dead pig.

- 10 The researchers say their goals are to one day increase the supply of human organs for transplant by allowing doctors to obtain viable organs long after death. And, they say, they hope their technology might also be used to prevent severe damage to hearts after a devastating heart attack or brains after a major stroke.

- 15 But the findings are just a first step, said Stephen Latham, a bioethicist at Yale University who worked closely with the group. The technology, he emphasized, is "very far away from use in humans." The group, led by Dr. Nenad Sestan, professor of neuroscience at the Yale School of Medicine, was stunned by its ability to revive cells. "We did not know what to expect," said Dr. David Andrijevic, also a neuroscientist at Yale and one of the authors of the paper. "Everything we restored was incredible to us."

- 20 Others not associated with the work were similarly astonished. "It's unbelievable, mind blowing," said Nita Farahany, a Duke law professor who studies the implications of emerging technologies. And, Dr. Farahany added, the work raises ethical questions about the definition of death. "We presume death is an irreversible state," she said. "Are there forms of death that are reversible? Or not?"

- 25 When they treated the dead pigs, the investigators took precautions to make sure the animals did not suffer. The pigs were anesthetized before they were killed by stopping their hearts, and the deep anesthesia continued throughout the experiment. In addition, the nerve blockers in the trailblazing solution stop nerves from firing in order to ensure the brain was not active. The researchers also chilled the animals to slow chemical reactions. Individual brain cells were alive, but there was no indication of any organized global nerve activity in the brain.

- 30 Yale has filed for a patent on the technology. The next step, Dr. Sestan said, will be to see if the organs function properly and could be successfully transplanted. Some time after that, the researchers hope to test whether the method can repair damaged hearts or brains.

The journal Nature asked two independent experts to write commentaries about the study. In one, Dr. Robert Porte, a transplant surgeon at the University of Groningen in the Netherlands, discussed the possible use of the system to expand the pool of organs available for transplant. He explained that OrganEx might in the future be used in situations in which patients are not brain-dead but brain-injured to the extent that life support is futile.

In most countries, Dr. Porte said, there is a five-minute “no touch” policy after life support is turned off and before transplant surgeons retrieve organs. But, he said, “before you rush to the operating room, additional minutes will pass by,” and by that time organs can be so damaged as to be unusable. And sometimes patients don’t die immediately when life support is ceased, but their hearts beat too feebly for their organs to stay healthy. “In most countries, transplant teams wait two hours” for patients to die, Dr. Porte said. Then, he said, if the patient is not yet dead, they do not proceed. As a result, 50 to 60 percent of patients who died after life support was ceased and whose families wanted to donate their organs cannot be donors. If OrganEx could revive those organs, Dr. Porte said, the effect “would be huge” — a vast increase in the number of organs ready for transplant.

The other comment was by Brendan Parent, a lawyer and ethicist who is director of transplant ethics and policy research at New York University’s Grossman School of Medicine. He discussed what he said were “tricky questions around life and death” that OrganEx raises. “By the accepted medical and legal definition of death, these pigs were dead,” Mr. Parent said. Would the pigs still be dead if the group did not use nerve blockers in its solution and their brains functioned again? That would create ethical problems if the goal was to preserve organs for transplant and the pigs regained some degree of consciousness during the process. But restoring brain functions could be the goal if the patient had had a severe stroke or was a drowning victim. “If we are going to get this technology to a point where it can help people, we will have to see what happens in the brain without nerve blockers,” Mr. Parent said.

Another issue is the implications OrganEx might have for the definition of death. If OrganEx continues to show that the length of time between the end of life support and the moment from which cells cannot recover is much longer than previously thought, then there has to be a change in the time when it is determined that a person is dead. “It’s weird but no different than what we went through with the development of the ventilator,” Mr. Parent said. “There is a whole population of people who in a different era might have been called dead,” he said.

Reading Text III: The Lincoln Highway

The following text is an excerpt of a novel set in the USA in the 1950s. The main character is young Emmett Watson.

June 12, 1954—The drive from Salina to Morgen was three hours, and for much of it, Emmett Watson hadn't said a word. For the first sixty miles or so, Warden Williams had made an effort at friendly conversation. He had told a few stories about his childhood back East and asked a few questions about Emmett's on the farm. But this was the last they'd be together, and Emmett didn't see much sense in going into all of that now. So when they crossed the border from Kansas into Nebraska and the warden turned on the radio, Emmett stared out the window at the prairie, keeping his thoughts to himself.

When they were five miles south of town, Emmett pointed through the windshield.

—You take that next right. It'll be the white house about four miles down the road.

10 The warden slowed his car and took the turn. They drove past the McKusker place, then the Andersens' with its matching pair of large red barns. A few minutes later they could see Emmett's house standing beside a small grove of oak trees about thirty yards from the road. To Emmett, all the houses in this part of the country looked like they'd been dropped from the sky. The Watson house just looked like it'd had a rougher landing. [...]

15 When they got within a hundred feet of the driveway, the warden pulled to the side of the road.

—Emmett, he said, with his hands on the wheel, before we drive in there's something I'd like to say.

20 That Warden Williams had something to say didn't come as much of a surprise. When Emmett had first arrived at Salina, the warden was a Hoosier named Ackerly, who wasn't inclined to put into words a piece of advice that could be delivered more efficiently with a stick. But Warden Williams was a modern man with a master's degree and good intentions and a framed photograph of Franklin D. Roosevelt hanging behind his desk. He had notions that he'd gathered from books and experience, and he had plenty of words at his disposal to turn them into counsel.

25 —For some of the young men who come to Salina, he began, whatever series of events has brought them under our sphere of influence is just the beginning of a long journey through a life of trouble. They're boys who were never given much sense of right or wrong as children and who see little reason for learning it now. Whatever values or ambitions we try to instill in them will, in all likelihood, be cast aside the moment they walk out from under our gaze. Sadly, for these boys it is only a matter of time before they find themselves in the correctional facility at Topeka, or worse.

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The warden turned to Emmett.

—What I'm getting at, Emmett, is that you are not one of them. We haven't known each other long, but from my time with you I can tell that that boy's death weighs heavily on your conscience. No one imagines what happened that night reflects either the spirit of malice or an expression of your character. It was the ugly side of chance. But as a civilized society, we ask that even those who have had an unintended hand in the misfortune of others pay some retribution. Of course, the payment of the retribution is in part to satisfy those who've suffered the brunt of the misfortune—like this boy's family. But we also require that it be paid for the benefit of the young man who was the agent of misfortune. So that by having the opportunity to pay his debt, he too can find some solace, some sense of atonement, and thus begin the process of renewal. Do you understand me, Emmett?

—I do, sir.

—I'm glad to hear it. I know you've got your brother to care for now and the immediate future may seem daunting; but you're a bright young man and you've got your whole life ahead of you. Having paid your debt in full, I just hope you'll make the most of your liberty.

—That's what I intend to do, Warden.

And in that moment, Emmett meant it. Because he agreed with most of what the warden said. He knew in the strongest of terms that his whole life was ahead of him and he knew that he needed to care for his brother. He knew too that he had been an agent of misfortune rather than its author. But he didn't agree that his debt had been paid in full. For no matter how much chance has played a role, when by your hands you have brought another man's time on earth to its end, to prove to the Almighty that you are worthy of his mercy, that shouldn't take any less than the rest of your life.

The warden put the car in gear and turned into the Watsons'. In the clearing by the front porch were two cars—a sedan and a pickup. The warden parked beside the pickup. When he and Emmett got out of the car, a tall man with a cowboy hat in his hand came out the front door and off the porch.

—Hey there, Emmett.

—Hey, Mr. Ransom.

The warden extended his hand to the rancher.

—I'm Warden Williams. It was nice of you to take the trouble to meet us.

—It was no trouble, Warden.

—I gather you've known Emmett a long time.

—Since the day he was born.

The warden put a hand on Emmett's shoulder.

—Then I don't need to explain to you what a fine young man he is. I was just telling him in the car that having paid his debt to society, he's got his whole life ahead of him.

—He does at that, agreed Mr. Ransom. The three men stood without speaking.

70 The warden had lived in the Midwest for less than a year now, but he knew from standing at the foot of other farmhouse porches that at this point in a conversation you were likely to be invited inside and offered something cool to drink; and when you received the invitation, you should be ready to accept because it would be taken as rude if you were to decline, even if you did have a three-hour drive ahead of you. But neither Emmett nor Mr. Ransom made any indication of asking the warden in.

75 —Well, he said after a moment, I guess I should be heading back. Emmett and Mr. Ransom offered a final thanks to the warden, shook his hand, then watched as he climbed in his car and drove away.